Data Loop
Interactive Artwork
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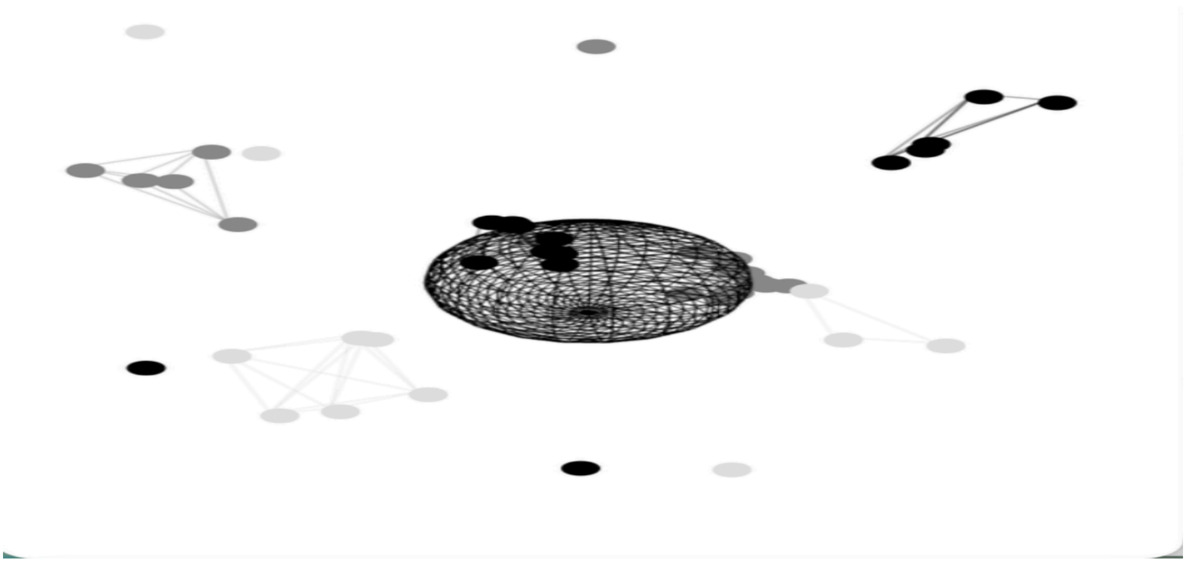
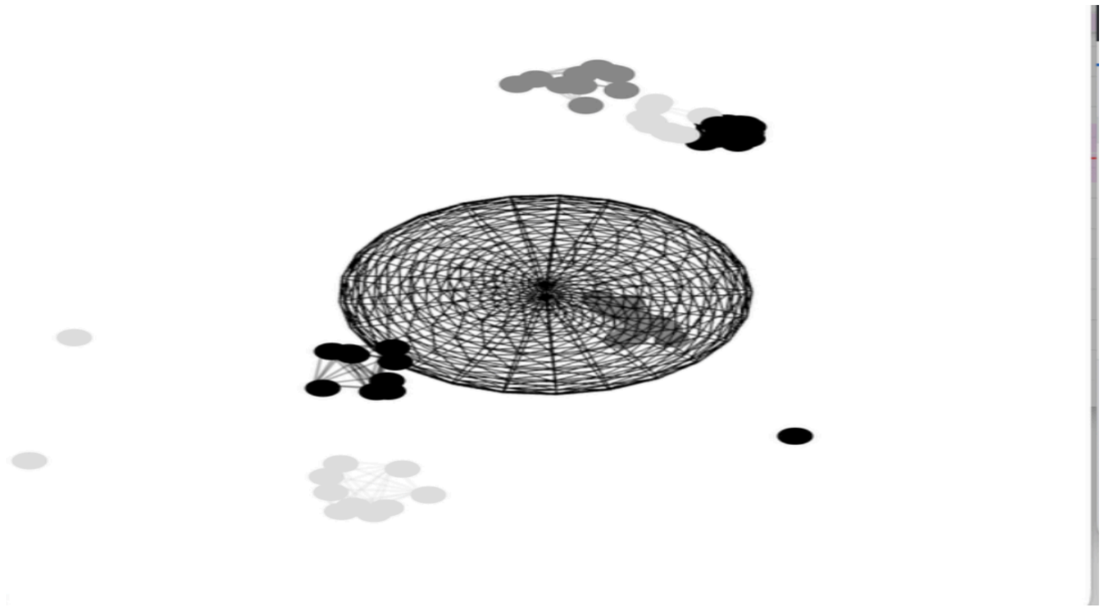
Screen Documentation

Start screen showing the introduction, instructions, and animated data background.
The start screen introduces the project and gives instructions to the user. It also shows an animated background that represents data already moving in the system.



The sphere grows each time a new identity is created from connected data. It shows how small actions build into a bigger identity over time.



Sphere growing as identities are generated through clustered data.

The sphere grows each time a new identity is created from connected data. It shows how small actions build into a bigger identity over time.

Transition phase where grouped data is visualized entering the system.

The transition phase shows the grouped data coming together and entering the system. It helps the user understand that their actions are being processed and turned into structured data.

Archive screen displaying stored identities and system output.
The archive screen shows all the identities created, with basic information like ID, name, and country. It represents how data is stored in a system and makes the user realize their actions are kept and organized, not lost.

Project Intentions

This project is about showing how small digital actions can turn into data and build an identity over time. The main idea was to take something very simple, like clicking, and show how it can become part of a bigger system that collects and organizes information.

When the user clicks on the screen, they create data points. These points move around and connect with each other based on similarity. After a certain amount of connections, the system generates a new identity. This identity is represented by a sphere that grows each time a new identity is created.

The goal of the project is to make data collection visible. In real life, we are always creating data but we don't see where it goes. This project tries to show that process in a visual way so the user can understand how their actions are being used and stored.

Project Development

This project is based on my first project but I decided to expand it. In the first version, I was only connecting dots and creating a user. It was more focused on the interaction itself and stopped once the identity was created.

For this project, I wanted to go further and show the full process of data. I started thinking about what happens after the data is created. Where does it go and how is it stored?

That's why I added more stages to the experience. First there is the start screen, then the interaction where the user creates data, then a transition phase, and finally the archive page.

The archive page is really important for the concept. I added things like ID numbers, names, countries, and status for each identity. This was to show how systems can store personal data and turn people into entries in a database. It makes the project feel more real and also shows the impact of data collection and how information can be used without the user really controlling it.

Implementation and Techniques

The project was built using HTML, CSS and JavaScript. The data points are created using simple div elements, and the connections between them are also drawn using lines.

JavaScript controls everything in the system. It handles the movement of the dots, the distance between them, and how they connect. I used simple math like distance calculations and sine and cosine to make the movement feel more natural.

For the 3D part, I used Three.js to create the sphere. The sphere grows every time a new identity is created. This helps connect the data system to something visual and central.

I also used requestAnimationFrame to keep everything animated in real time. This makes the system feel alive and always changing.

Tutorials and Inspiration

I used online tutorials to understand how to build the 3D part of the project and how to structure the animation.

Three.js Crash Course
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q7AOvWpIVHU

This tutorial helped me understand the basics of Three.js. I learned how to create a scene, a camera, and a renderer. It also showed how to animate objects. I used this knowledge to create the sphere and make it rotate and grow in my project.

Three.js Tutorial for Beginners
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YKzyhcyAijo

This tutorial helped me understand how to create shapes and apply materials. It was useful for building the wireframe sphere and adjusting how it looks. I adapted what I learned to match the style of my project.

Reference Reading 1

Data Feminism by Catherine D'Ignazio and Lauren Klein

This reading explains that data is not neutral. It is created and used by systems that can have bias. Data is not just numbers, it represents real people and real situations.

What I understood from this is that data systems simplify people. In my project, the archive page shows identities with only basic information like ID, country, and status. This reflects how real systems reduce people into data and remove complexity.

Reference Reading 2

Mimi Onuoha — Missing Data Sets

This work talks about how some data is never collected and how that absence is important. Not everything is recorded, and what is missing can also tell a story.

From this reading, I understood that data systems are incomplete. In my project, even if the archive looks full, it is still only a small part of reality. It made me think about what is not shown in the system.

Conclusion

This project helped me understand how interaction and code can be used to express an idea. It shows how simple actions can become part of a larger system and how data can be collected and stored.

By expanding from my first project, I was able to go beyond just creating data and show the full process, from interaction to archive. The project reflects how digital systems work and makes the user think about the impact of their action

FINAL PROJECT VIDEO

https://www.loom.com/share/39e12cf56ac34a738a5eba1d637f862e